Career Ka Dost

Ask before you decide

Class 10 Social Science

5 Sample Papers

Board Exam 2027 | CBSE 2026-27 syllabus | Latest 4-section paper pattern

5 full-length practice papers of 80 marks each (3 hours, 38 questions), with a map sheet for every paper.

Paper	Difficulty
Paper 1	Easy
Paper 2	Moderate to Hard
Paper 3	Moderate to Hard
Paper 4	Moderate to Hard
Paper 5	Hard

Sample Paper 1

CLASS 10 | SOCIAL SCIENCE

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Easy

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **38** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper is divided into **four sections**: Section A (History), Section B (Geography), Section C (Political Science) and Section D (Economics). Each section carries **20 marks**.
3. **Section A:** Q1-4 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q5 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q6 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q7 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q8 is a source-based question (4 marks). Q9 is a map question (2 marks).
4. **Section B:** Q10-15 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q16 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q17 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q18 is a case-based question (4 marks). Q19 is a map question (3 marks).
5. **Section C:** Q20-23 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q24 and Q25 are very short answer questions (2 marks each, about 40 words). Q26 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q27 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q28 is a case-based question (4 marks).
6. **Section D:** Q29-34 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q35-37 are short answer questions (3 marks each, about 60 words). Q38 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words).
7. There is **internal choice** in Q5, Q6, Q7, Q17, Q27, Q38. Attempt only one of the given alternatives in these questions.
8. Questions 9 and 19 are map questions. Use the **Map Sheet** given on the last page of this paper, write your Roll Number on it and attach it to your answer book.
9. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A – HISTORY (20 Marks)

1. Which city was added to Italy in 1870, completing the unification of the country? **[1]**

(A) Venice **(B)** Rome
(C) Naples **(D)** Milan

2. Find the odd one out among Gandhiji's early Satyagrahas in India: **[1]**

(A) Champaran **(B)** Kheda
(C) Ahmedabad **(D)** Chauri Chaura

3. Who among the following wrote 'Gulamgiri' (1871), a book that attacked the caste system? **[1]**

(A) Jyotiba Phule **(B)** B.R. Ambedkar
(C) E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker **(D)** Kashibaba

4. Which social reformer wrote 'Stripurushtulna' (1882), a critique of the social differences between men and women? **[1]**

(A) Tarabai Shinde **(B)** Pandita Ramabai
(C) Rashsundari Debi **(D)** Kailashbashini Debi

5. (A) Why did the Romantics criticise the glorification of reason and science? **[2]**

OR

(B) What was 'ukiyo'? Name one Japanese artist associated with it.

6. (A) Explain how diseases such as smallpox helped the Spanish and Portuguese conquest of the Americas. **[3]**

OR

(B) Explain how trade along the Silk Routes helped in the spread of religion, art and culture.

7. (A) Explain the role of the industrialists in the Civil Disobedience Movement. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain how Dalits and Muslims reacted to the Civil Disobedience Movement.

8. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **The Vernacular Press Act** **[4]**

> The Vernacular Press Act was passed in 1878, modelled on the Irish Press Laws. It provided the government with extensive rights to censor reports and editorials in the vernacular press. From now on, the government kept regular track of the vernacular newspapers published in different provinces. When a report was judged as seditious, the newspaper was warned, and if the warning was ignored, the press was liable to be seized and the printing machinery confiscated. Despite repressive measures, nationalist newspapers grew in numbers in all parts of India. They reported on colonial misrule and encouraged nationalist activities. Attempts to censor reports provoked militant protest. This in turn led to a renewed cycle of persecution and protests.

(8.1) In which year was the Vernacular Press Act passed? **[1]**
(8.2) What powers did the Act give to the government? **[1]**
(8.3) How did nationalist newspapers respond to the repressive measures? Explain. **[2]**

9. Two places (A) and (B) have been marked on the given political outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper). Identify them based on the information given below and write their correct names on the lines marked near them: **[2]**
(A) The place where a crowd set a police station on fire in 1922, due to which Gandhiji called off the Non-Cooperation Movement.
(B) The coastal village in Gujarat where the Salt March ended on 6 April 1930.

SECTION B – GEOGRAPHY (20 Marks)

10. Which one of the following soils is considered best for the cultivation of cotton? **[1]**

(A) Alluvial soil **(B)** Black soil
(C) Laterite soil **(D)** Desert soil

11. Which one of the following is a Biosphere Reserve in India? **[1]**

(A) Nilgiri **(B)** Jharia
(C) Hirakud **(D)** Digboi

12. Species that are likely to move into the 'endangered' category in the near future if the factors threatening them continue to operate are called: **[1]**

(A) Normal species **(B)** Vulnerable species
(C) Extinct species **(D)** Endemic species

13. Which one of the following is a measure for the conservation of energy? **[1]**

(A) Using public transport instead of private vehicles
(B) Leaving lights on all day
(C) Using more electrical appliances than needed
(D) Wasting fuel

14. Bauxite is the main ore of which metal? **[1]**

(A) Iron **(B)** Copper
(C) Aluminium **(D)** Gold

15. The Chotanagpur plateau region is rich in which of the following minerals? **[1]**

(A) Coal and iron ore **(B)** Natural gas
(C) Uranium only **(D)** Limestone only

16. State any two technological and institutional reforms introduced to improve Indian agriculture. **[2]**

17. (A) Describe the importance of hydroelectric power and the problems associated with large dams. **[5]**

OR

(B) Describe any three non-conventional sources of energy and their advantages.

18. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Rat-hole mining** **[4]**

> In most of the tribal belts of the north-east India, minerals are owned by individuals or communities. In Meghalaya, there are large deposits of coal, iron ore, limestone and dolomite. Coal mining in Jowai and Cherapunjee is done by family members in the form of a long narrow tunnel, known as 'rat-hole' mining. Mining is a hazardous activity for the miners and the environment. The dust and noxious fumes inhale by miners make them vulnerable to pulmonary diseases. The risk of roof collapse, inundation and fires in coalmines is a constant threat to miners. The water sources in the region get contaminated due to mining. Mining leads to degradation of land, soil erosion and increased streams and river pollution.

(18.1) What is 'rat-hole' mining? **[1]**
(18.2) Name two health risks faced by miners. **[1]**
(18.3) Explain any two ways in which mining damages the environment. **[2]**

19. On the same outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper), locate and label any THREE of the following with suitable symbols: **[3]**
(i) Tarapur Nuclear Power Plant
(ii) Software Technology Park at Bengaluru
(iii) Nagarjuna Sagar Dam
(iv) New Mangalore Port

SECTION C – POLITICAL SCIENCE (20 Marks)

20. Between 1970 and 1993, the Belgian Constitution was amended how many times to work out an arrangement acceptable to all communities? **[1]**

(A) Once **(B)** Two times
(C) Four times **(D)** Ten times

21. Who makes laws on the subjects in the Union List? **[1]**

(A) State Legislatures **(B)** The Union Parliament
(C) Local bodies **(D)** The Supreme Court

22. Using religious symbols and religious leaders to bring the followers of one religion together in the political arena is an example of: **[1]**

(A) Secularism **(B)** Communal politics
(C) Federalism **(D)** Universal franchise

23. A government which follows the procedures of the law and is accepted by the people as their own government is called: **[1]**

(A) A legitimate government **(B)** A temporary government
(C) An authoritarian government **(D)** A colonial government

24. What is a coalition government? When does it come into being? **[2]**

25. State any two reasons for the success of the federal system in India. **[2]**

26. Explain with examples any three ways in which religion is used in Indian politics. **[3]**

27. (A) Describe the major features of a federation, with reference to India. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain the role of political parties in running a democratic government.

28. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **The Gram Panchayat and the Gram Sabha** **[4]**

> Each village, or a group of villages in some States, has a Gram Panchayat. This is a council consisting of several ward members, often called Panch, and a president or Sarpanch. They are directly elected by all the adult population living in that ward or village. It is the decision-making body for the entire village. The Panchayat works under the overall supervision of the Gram Sabha. All the voters in the village are its members. It has to meet at least twice or thrice in a year to approve the annual budget of the Gram Panchayat and to review the performance of the Gram Panchayat.

(28.1) Who elects the members of the Gram Panchayat? **[1]**
(28.2) Who are the members of the Gram Sabha? **[1]**
(28.3) Explain any two functions of the Gram Sabha. **[2]**

SECTION D – ECONOMICS (20 Marks)

29. When people deposit money in a bank, the bank uses a major part of the deposits to: **[1]**

(A) Extend loans to people who need money **(B)** Build its own factories
(C) Print currency notes **(D)** Pay the salaries of ministers

30. Amul, which collects milk from farmers and sells milk products, is an example of the: **[1]**

(A) Public sector **(B)** Private sector
(C) Cooperative sector **(D)** Joint sector

31. In which of the following forms is most of the money in modern economies held? **[1]**

(A) Gold coins **(B)** Demand deposits in banks
(C) Silver bars **(D)** Barter goods

32. Which institution issues currency notes in India? **[1]**

(A) State Bank of India **(B)** Reserve Bank of India
(C) Ministry of Finance **(D)** Commercial banks

33. Which one of the following facilities is generally available to workers in the organised sector? **[1]**

(A) Job security and paid leave **(B)** Daily wages without any contract
(C) No fixed working hours **(D)** No rules on working conditions

34. The developmental goal of a landless rural labourer is most likely to be: **[1]**

(A) More days of work and better wages **(B)** Higher support prices for crops
(C) Electricity for a big factory **(D)** A large tractor

35. Distinguish between the public sector and the private sector with one example of each. **[3]**

36. Why is sustainable development necessary? Explain with examples. **[3]**

37. Explain the role of technology in the process of globalisation with two examples. **[3]**

38. (A) Explain the importance of the primary, secondary and tertiary sectors in the Indian economy. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain the role of the Reserve Bank of India and commercial banks in the Indian economy.

- End of Question Paper -

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MAP SHEET for Question Numbers 9 and 19

Sample Paper 1 | Roll No. _____ | Detach and attach to your answer book



Sample Paper 2

CLASS 10 | SOCIAL SCIENCE

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Moderate to Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

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8. Questions 9 and 19 are map questions. Use the **Map Sheet** given on the last page of this paper, write your Roll Number on it and attach it to your answer book.
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SECTION A – HISTORY (20 Marks)

1. The Civil Code of 1804, usually known as the Napoleonic Code, did away with: **[1]**

(A) All privileges based on birth
(B) The use of a common law
(C) The right to property
(D) Equality before the law

2. **Assertion (A):** Martin Luther's Ninety Five Theses (1517) led to a division within the Church. **[1]**
Reason (R): Luther's writings were printed in large numbers, widely read and led to a division within the Church and the beginning of the Protestant Reformation.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

3. **Assertion (A):** The conquest of the Americas by the Europeans in the sixteenth century was made much easier by the spread of diseases. **[1]**
Reason (R): The native people of America had no immunity against diseases such as smallpox which were carried by the Europeans.
Choose the correct option.
(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

4. Which two leaders of the Khilafat Movement joined hands with Gandhiji in 1920? **[1]**
(A) Muhammad Ali and Shaukat Ali
(B) Mohammad Ali Jinnah and Liaquat Ali Khan
(C) Maulana Azad and Sir Syed
(D) Hasan Imam and Iqbal

5. (A) How did the 'Balkan' nationalism become a source of tension in Europe after 1871? State any two points. **[2]**

OR

(B) Why was Ireland forcibly incorporated into the United Kingdom in 1801? State any two points.

6. (A) Explain any three features of the world economy in the inter-war period that made it unstable. **[3]**

OR

(B) Explain any three reasons why the Indian indentured labourers migrated to other countries in the nineteenth century.

7. (A) 'The First World War created a new economic and political situation in India.' Analyse the statement. **[5]**

OR

(B) 'The conquest of the Americas by the Europeans was aided as much by disease as by arms.' Evaluate the statement.

8. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Germania and Marianne: women as allegories of the nation** **[4]**

> Artists in the nineteenth century represented a country as if it were a person. Nations were then portrayed as female figures. The female figure was chosen as an allegory of the nation. She did not stand for any particular woman in real life; rather it sought to give an abstract idea of the nation a concrete form. Thus, the female figure became an allegory of the nation. In France, she was christened Marianne, a popular Christian name, which underlined the idea of a people's nation. Her characteristics were drawn from those of Liberty and the Republic - the red cap, the tricolour, the cockade. Statues of Marianne were erected in public squares to remind the public of the national symbol of unity and to persuade them to identify with it. In Germany, Germania became the allegory of the German nation. In visual representations, Germania wears a crown of oak leaves, as the German oak stands for heroism.

(8.1) Who was the female allegory of the French nation? **[1]**
(8.2) What does the crown of oak leaves worn by Germania symbolise? **[1]**
(8.3) Why did the artists of the nineteenth century choose female figures as allegories of the nation? Explain. **[2]**

9. Two places (A) and (B) have been marked on the given political outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper). Identify them based on the information given below and write their correct names on the lines marked near them: **[2]**
(A) The coastal village in Gujarat where the Salt March ended on 6 April 1930.
(B) The place where the Congress session of December 1927 was held.

SECTION B – GEOGRAPHY (20 Marks)

10. Which one of the following is an example of 'reserves' as a type of resource? **[1]**
(A) Water in a dam which can be used for hydroelectric power
(B) Uranium in unused rocks
(C) Wind energy not yet harnessed
(D) Solar energy not yet used

11. Which one of the following is a major objective of the Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972? **[1]**
(A) To ban hunting and to protect the habitats of wildlife
(B) To permit the hunting of all animals
(C) To clear forests for agriculture
(D) To encourage the export of wildlife products

12. Match dams (I to IV) with rivers (a to d) and choose the correct option: **[1]**
Column I
I. Hirakud
II. Rana Pratap Sagar
III. Salal
IV. Tungabhadra
Column II
(a) Chenab
(b) Chambal
(c) Mahanadi
(d) Tungabhadra
(A) I-c, II-b, III-a, IV-d **(B)** I-c, II-a, III-b, IV-d
(C) I-b, II-c, III-a, IV-d **(D)** I-d, II-b, III-a, IV-c

13. **Assertion (A):** Intensive subsistence farming is practised in areas of high population pressure on land. **[1]**
Reason (R): The farm size is small and the farmers use high doses of biochemical inputs and irrigation with intensive labour.
Choose the correct option.
(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

14. Air pollution caused by industries is mainly due to the presence of: **[1]**
(A) Undesirable gases such as sulphur dioxide and carbon monoxide
(B) Fresh oxygen
(C) Rainwater
(D) Sea breeze

15. Which one of the following is an agro-based industry? **[1]**
(A) Cement industry **(B)** Iron and steel industry
(C) Cotton textile industry **(D)** Aluminium smelting

16. State any two methods of controlling the air pollution caused by industries. **[2]**

17. (A) Compare the intensive subsistence farming with the commercial farming in India on the basis of any five points. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain any five problems faced by the Indian agriculture and suggest remedies.

18. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Water scarcity** **[4]**

> Water scarcity is most often assumed to be the outcome of a lack of rainfall. But it is not always so. Water scarcity may be an outcome of excessive use and unequal access to water among different social groups. A large population means more water is required not only for domestic use but also to produce more food. Hence, to facilitate higher food-grain production, water resources are being over-exploited to expand irrigated areas for dry-season agriculture. Industrialisation and urbanisation have also added to the problem. Most cities in India are facing a problem of water scarcity because large amounts of water are used by housing societies and colonies, which depend on groundwater. Water scarcity is also caused by the pollution of water by industrial effluents and by chemical fertilisers and pesticides.

(18.1) What is the common assumption about the cause of water scarcity? **[1]**
(18.2) Mention one effect of urbanisation on water resources. **[1]**
(18.3) Explain any two causes of water scarcity mentioned in the passage. **[2]**

19. On the same outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper), locate and label any THREE of the following with suitable symbols: **[3]**
(i) Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport (Kolkata)
(ii) Tungabhadra Dam
(iii) Chennai Port
(iv) Kakrapara Nuclear Power Plant

SECTION C – POLITICAL SCIENCE (20 Marks)

20. Which one of the following statements about Belgium is correct? **[1]**
(A) About 59 per cent of the population lives in the Flemish region and speaks Dutch
(B) About 80 per cent of the population lives in the capital Brussels
(C) Most Belgians speak German
(D) Belgium has only one official language

21. According to the Indian Constitution, Hindi was identified as the official language. About how much of India's population has Hindi as its mother tongue? **[1]**
(A) About 10 per cent **(B)** About 25 per cent
(C) About 40 per cent **(D)** About 75 per cent

22. Which one of the following best defines 'democracy as a better form of government'? **[1]**
(A) It provides a method to deal with differences and conflicts and allows citizens to take part in decisions
(B) It always ensures economic equality
(C) It gives all powers to one leader
(D) It does not need elections

23. Which one of the following is a measure taken to reform political parties in India? **[1]**
(A) Banning small parties **(B)** Anti-defection law
(C) Giving more power to party leaders **(D)** Reducing the number of elections

24. Distinguish between the vertical and the horizontal division of power with one example of each. **[2]**

25. What is meant by 'residuary subjects'? Who has the power to make laws on them in India? **[2]**

26. Why is competition among political parties essential for a democracy? Explain with three points. **[3]**

27. (A) Explain any five challenges faced by political parties in India. **[5]**

OR

(B) 'Democracy produces an accountable, responsive and legitimate government.' Examine the statement.

28. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Communalism** **[4]**

> Communalism involves religious prejudices, stereotypes of religious communities and belief in the superiority of one's religion over other religions. This is a frequent belief among many people. A communal mind often leads to a quest for political dominance of one's own religious community. For those belonging to the majority community, this takes the form of majoritarian dominance. For those belonging to the minority community, it can take the form of a desire to form a separate political unit. Political mobilisation on religious lines is another frequent form of communalism. This involves the use of sacred symbols, religious leaders, emotional appeal and plain fear in order to bring the followers of one religion together in the political arena. In the extreme form, communalism leads to violence, riots and massacre.

(28.1) What is the belief on which communalism is based? **[1]**
(28.2) How does communalism take different forms among the majority and the minority communities? **[1]**
(28.3) Why is communal politics dangerous for a democracy? Explain with two points. **[2]**

SECTION D – ECONOMICS (20 Marks)

29. The Human Development Index (HDI) is best described as: **[1]**

(A) It is a composite index which takes into account health, education and income indicators
(B) It is based only on the per capita income of the country
(C) It measures only the literacy rate
(D) It is published by the Reserve Bank of India

30. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 guarantees: **[1]**

(A) Government jobs to all in villages
(B) 100 days of employment in a year to every rural household whose adult members volunteer to do unskilled manual work
(C) Free food to every family
(D) Loans to every farmer

31. Rohan's father runs a small cloth shop with four helpers. The shop is not registered, income is irregular, and there is no provision for pension. His work belongs to: **[1]**

(A) The organised sector
(B) The unorganised sector
(C) The public sector
(D) The primary sector

32. A person is able to buy anything with money, which is a medium of exchange, because: **[1]**

(A) Money is generally accepted for payment, and its acceptance is backed by law
(B) Money is made of gold
(C) Everyone is forced to barter
(D) Banks print money

33. Which one of the following has played the most important role in connecting the production and markets in different countries? **[1]**

(A) Information and communication technology such as telecommunications and satellite links
(B) Increase in import duties
(C) A fall in the number of banks
(D) A ban on foreign travel

34. The share of agriculture in India's GDP has: **[1]**

(A) Increased since 1950
(B) Declined since 1950, but a large share of workers still depends on it
(C) Remained the same
(D) Become zero

35. Analyse any three reasons for the shift of employment from the primary sector to the tertiary sector in India. **[3]**

36. Why is per capita income not a complete criterion for comparing the development of countries? Explain with three points. **[3]**

37. What is meant by globalisation? Explain the role of multinational corporations in this process. **[3]**

38. (A) Describe the role of banks in the credit system and explain why credit is necessary for economic activities. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain the importance of the three sectors and the changing pattern of employment in India.

- End of Question Paper -

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MAP SHEET for Question Numbers 9 and 19

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Sample Paper 3

CLASS 10 | SOCIAL SCIENCE

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SECTION A – HISTORY (20 Marks)

1. Giuseppe Mazzini founded two underground societies to spread his ideas. They were: **[1]**

(A) Young Italy and Young Europe
(B) Carbonari and Red Shirts
(C) Zollverein and Young Italy
(D) Jacobins and Young Europe

2. Read the following statements about the Salt March and choose the correct option: **[1]**

I. It began from Sabarmati Ashram on 12 March 1930.
II. Gandhiji was accompanied by 78 volunteers.
III. It covered about 240 miles and ended at Dandi.
IV. At Dandi, Gandhiji broke the salt law on 6 April.

(A) Only I and II are correct
(B) Only II and III are correct
(C) Only I, III and IV are correct
(D) I, II, III and IV are all correct

3. **Assertion (A):** The Silk Routes got their name from the Chinese silk that was carried along them. **[1]**

Reason (R): Chinese silk was in great demand in Rome and other markets, and trade along the routes also carried ideas, religions and diseases.

Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

4. Which one of the following was a result of the Congress of Vienna (1815)? **[1]**

(A) The Bourbon dynasty was restored to power in France
(B) The French Republic was declared
(C) Italy was unified
(D) The Frankfurt Parliament was formed

5. (A) Name any two items that travelled along the Silk Routes and state how they helped in the exchange of cultures. **[2]**

OR

(B) How did the arrival of the potato change the lives of poor people in Europe? Explain with one example.

6. (A) Explain the circumstances under which the Simon Commission was set up and how Indians reacted to it. **[3]**

OR

(B) Explain how the image of Bharat Mata and folklore helped in creating a sense of collective belonging.

7. (A) Explain how the Greek War of Independence mobilised nationalist feelings among the educated elite of Europe. **[5]**

OR

(B) How did the Khilafat issue help in building Hindu-Muslim unity in the national movement? Explain with any five points.

8. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Gulamgiri and the caste debates** **[4]**

> Caste questions were also debated in print. The 'lower caste' protest movements and sects argued for reform and a better life for the low castes. Jyotiba Phule, the Maratha pioneer of 'low caste' protest movements, wrote about the injustices of the caste system in his Gulamgiri (1871). In the twentieth century, B.R. Ambedkar in Maharashtra and E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker in Madras, better known as Periyar, wrote powerfully on caste and their writings were read all over India. Local protest movements and sects also created a flood of popular journals and tracts that criticised ancient scriptures and envisioned a new and just future. Workers in factories were too overworked and lacked the education to write much about their experiences. But Kashibaba, a Kanpur mill worker, wrote and published Chhote Aur Bade Ka Sawal in 1938 to show the link between caste and class exploitation.

(8.1) Who wrote 'Gulamgiri' and in which year? **[1]**
(8.2) Name the book written by Kashibaba in 1938. **[1]**
(8.3) How did the print media help the lower castes to raise their voice against injustice? Explain. **[2]**

9. Two places (A) and (B) have been marked on the given political outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper). Identify them based on the information given below and write their correct names on the lines marked near them: **[2]**
(A) The place where the Congress session of December 1927 was held.
(B) The place where the Congress adopted the goal of complete independence in 1929.

SECTION B - GEOGRAPHY (20 Marks)

10. Which one of the following is a characteristic of arid soils? **[1]**

(A) They are rich in humus
(B) They are sandy and saline, with low humus content
(C) They are formed by lava
(D) They are deposited by rivers

11. The 'Bhoodan-Gramdan' movement, in which landowners were persuaded to donate land to landless farmers, is associated with: **[1]**

(A) Mahatma Gandhi **(B)** Vinoba Bhave
(C) Jayaprakash Narayan **(D)** Sundarlal Bahuguna

12. According to the IUCN classification, species whose population has been declining and which will move into the endangered category if the adverse factors continue to operate are called: **[1]**

(A) Vulnerable species **(B)** Rare species
(C) Extinct species **(D)** Normal species

13. The practice of 'shifting cultivation' is known by different names in different regions. Which one of the following is the name used in Mexico? **[1]**

(A) Milpa **(B)** Ray
(C) Jhumming **(D)** Ladang

14. Which of the following is a feature of the tertiary sector industries? **[1]**

(A) They provide service-based activities such as trade, transport and banking
(B) They convert raw material into finished goods
(C) They produce raw materials
(D) They are only in the villages

15. A sanctuary differs from a national park in that: **[1]**

(A) Some activities such as grazing can be permitted in a sanctuary, while a national park has stricter protection
(B) Sanctuaries are meant only for plants
(C) Hunting is allowed in sanctuaries without limits
(D) National parks have no boundaries

16. Distinguish between the Kharif and the Rabi cropping seasons with one example of a crop of each. **[2]**

17. (A) What is rainwater harvesting? Explain its importance and any three traditional methods. **[5]**

OR

(B) Compare thermal power and hydroelectric power with respect to their sources, advantages and locations.

18. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Conservation of energy resources** **[4]**

> Energy is a basic requirement for economic development. Every sector of the national economy - agriculture, industry, transport, commercial and domestic - needs inputs of energy. The economic development plans implemented since Independence necessitated increasing amounts of energy to remain consumed in all the sectors. As a result, energy consumption in the country has been increasing steadily. There is an urgent need to develop a sustainable path of energy development. Promotion of energy conservation and increased use of renewable energy sources are the twin planks of sustainable energy. India is presently one of the least energy efficient countries in the world. We have to adopt a cautious approach for the judicious use of our limited energy resources. For example, as concerned citizens we can contribute by using public transport instead of individual vehicles, switching off electricity when not in use, using power-saving devices and using non-conventional sources of energy.

(18.1) What are the twin planks of sustainable energy according to the passage? **[1]**
(18.2) Mention any one way in which a citizen can conserve energy. **[1]**
(18.3) Why is it necessary to adopt a cautious approach in the use of energy resources? Explain with two points. **[2]**

19. On the same outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper), locate and label any THREE of the following with suitable symbols: **[3]**
(i) Salal Dam
(ii) Haldia Port
(iii) Narora Nuclear Power Plant
(iv) Software Technology Park at Hyderabad

SECTION C – POLITICAL SCIENCE (20 Marks)

20. Which one of the following is an example of horizontal distribution of power? **[1]**
(A) Power shared between the Union and the State governments
(B) Power shared among the legislature, the executive and the judiciary
(C) Power shared between the State and local governments
(D) Power shared among social groups

21. Read the statements about the outcomes of democracy: **[1]**
I. Democracy produces a government that is accountable to the citizens.
II. Democracy always guarantees a higher rate of economic growth than a dictatorship.
III. Democracy accommodates social diversity.
IV. Democracy promotes the dignity and freedom of the individual.
Which statements are correct?
(A) I, III and IV only
(B) I, II and III only
(C) II, III and IV only
(D) I, II, III and IV

22. **Assertion (A):** Decentralisation has made democracy more effective in India. **[1]**
Reason (R): Local people have better knowledge of the problems of their area and can find solutions that suit local conditions.
Choose the correct option.
(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

23. A party that secures at least six per cent of the total votes in an election to a State Legislative Assembly and wins at least two seats is recognised as a: **[1]**

(A) National party **(B)** State party
(C) Independent group **(D)** Pressure group

24. How did the 'Sinhala only' Act of 1956 deepen the feeling of alienation among the Sri Lankan Tamils? Explain with two points. **[2]**

25. How is religion used in politics in a way that leads to communal politics? Explain with two examples. **[2]**

26. Explain any three problems faced by the local government bodies in India. **[3]**

27. (A) Describe the three kinds of party systems with examples. Which system suits India best and why? **[5]**

OR

(B) 'Women are still under-represented in Indian politics.' Explain the statement and suggest measures to improve it.

28. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **The language policy of India** **[4]**

> The Constitution of India did not give the status of national language to any one language. Hindi was identified as the official language, but Hindi is the mother tongue of only about 40 per cent of Indians. Therefore, there were many safeguards to protect other languages. Besides Hindi, there are 21 other languages recognised as Scheduled Languages by the Constitution. A candidate in an examination conducted for the Central Government positions may opt to take the examination in any of these languages. States too have their own official languages. Much of the government work takes place in the official language of the concerned State. Unlike Sri Lanka, the leaders of our country adopted a very cautious attitude in spreading the use of Hindi. According to the Constitution, the use of English for official purposes was to stop in 1965. However, many non-Hindi speaking States demanded that the use of English continue. In Tamil Nadu, this movement took a violent form.

(28.1) How many Scheduled Languages are recognised by the Constitution, in addition to Hindi? **[1]**
(28.2) Why was the use of English allowed to continue as an official language? **[1]**
(28.3) Explain how India's language policy is different from that of Sri Lanka. **[2]**

SECTION D – ECONOMICS (20 Marks)

29. The following table shows the average income and literacy of four countries. Which country is the best developed in terms of the HDI components? **[1]**
A: Rs 90,000, literacy 95 per cent, infant mortality 8
B: Rs 95,000, literacy 60 per cent, infant mortality 55
C: Rs 70,000, literacy 70 per cent, infant mortality 30
D: Rs 100,000, literacy 50 per cent, infant mortality 65

(A) A **(B)** B
(C) C **(D)** D

30. A shopkeeper wants a bank loan to expand his shop. The bank has asked for a collateral. Which of the following can he offer? **[1]**

(A) The documents of his house or land **(B)** A promise to repay
(C) A list of customers **(D)** His identity card only

31. Ramesh needs a loan to buy a tractor. A moneylender in his village offers a loan at 5 per cent interest per month without any document. A nationalised bank offers a loan at a much lower interest rate with a requirement of collateral. Which is a better choice for Ramesh and why? **[1]**

(A) Moneylender, because no collateral is needed
(B) Bank, because it offers cheaper credit and supports income growth
(C) Moneylender, because the interest is lower
(D) Neither, because loans are always harmful

32. Rahim has to sell his crop immediately after harvest to repay a loan taken from a trader. This shows that: **[1]**

(A) Informal sources of credit can force borrowers to sell their produce at low prices
(B) Informal credit is always cheap
(C) Banks have refused to lend money to everyone
(D) Traders do not charge interest

33. The Gross Domestic Product (GDP) is the: **[1]**

(A) Value of all final goods and services produced within a country during a particular year
(B) Value of all the intermediate goods produced
(C) Total number of workers in a country
(D) Total income of the government

34. Which of the following is a reason for the rise of the tertiary sector in India? **[1]**

(A) Rising income leads to a demand for services such as tourism, shopping and private hospitals
(B) Closure of services
(C) Ban on banking
(D) Decline in income

35. The share of agriculture in India's GDP has fallen sharply but its share in employment has not fallen in the same way. Analyse the reasons and the problems it creates. **[3]**

36. Explain any three ways in which the cost of borrowing from informal sources is higher than that from formal sources. **[3]**

37. Explain the three terms of credit with the example of a farmer taking a loan for cultivation. **[3]**

38. (A) Explain the idea of 'sustainability of development' with the help of examples of non-renewable resources. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain the problems of unemployment and underemployment in India and suggest measures to solve them.

- End of Question Paper -

MAP SHEET for Question Numbers 9 and 19

Sample Paper 3 | Roll No. _____ | Detach and attach to your answer book



Sample Paper 4

CLASS 10 | SOCIAL SCIENCE

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Moderate to Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **38** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper is divided into **four sections**: Section A (History), Section B (Geography), Section C (Political Science) and Section D (Economics). Each section carries **20 marks**.
3. **Section A:** Q1-4 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q5 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q6 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q7 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q8 is a source-based question (4 marks). Q9 is a map question (2 marks).
4. **Section B:** Q10-15 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q16 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q17 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q18 is a case-based question (4 marks). Q19 is a map question (3 marks).
5. **Section C:** Q20-23 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q24 and Q25 are very short answer questions (2 marks each, about 40 words). Q26 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q27 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q28 is a case-based question (4 marks).
6. **Section D:** Q29-34 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q35-37 are short answer questions (3 marks each, about 60 words). Q38 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words).
7. There is **internal choice** in Q5, Q6, Q7, Q17, Q27, Q38. Attempt only one of the given alternatives in these questions.
8. Questions 9 and 19 are map questions. Use the **Map Sheet** given on the last page of this paper, write your Roll Number on it and attach it to your answer book.
9. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A – HISTORY (20 Marks)

1. Which of the following was the effect of the Corn Laws on British agriculture and industry in the early nineteenth century? **[1]**

I. The Corn Laws restricted the import of corn into Britain.
II. After their abolition, food could be imported into Britain more cheaply than it could be produced within the country.
III. British farmers abandoned farming and migrated to cities or overseas.
IV. After their abolition, the price of food in Britain rose sharply.

(A) I, II and III only
(B) I, III and IV only
(C) II and IV only
(D) I, II, III and IV

2. **Assertion (A):** The Balkan region became a source of serious nationalist tensions in Europe after 1871. **[1]**

Reason (R): A large part of the Balkans was under the control of the Ottoman Empire, which was disintegrating, and the idea of romantic nationalism spread among the Balkan people.

Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

3. Match the following works with their authors and choose the correct option: **[1]**

I. Gulamgiri
II. Amar Jiban
III. Chhote aur Bade ka Sawal
IV. Sacchi Kavitayan
(a) Rashsundari Debi; (b) Jyotiba Phule; (c) Sudarshan Chakra; (d) Kashibaba

(A) I-b, II-a, III-d, IV-c **(B)** I-a, II-b, III-d, IV-c
(C) I-b, II-a, III-c, IV-d **(D)** I-d, II-c, III-b, IV-a

4. Which one of the following was a measure introduced by Napoleon in the territories under his control to make the administration more rational? **[1]**

(A) The Civil Code of 1804, which did away with all privileges based on birth and established equality before the law
(B) The restoration of the monarchy and feudal dues
(C) The restoration of guilds
(D) The ban on private property

5. (A) Why did the conservative regimes set up after 1815 impose censorship laws? State any two reasons. **[2]**

OR

(B) How did the Greek struggle for independence mobilise nationalist feelings among the educated elite of Europe? State any two points.

6. (A) Explain any three reasons for the participation of the peasants of Awadh in the national movement under Baba Ramchandra. **[3]**

OR

(B) Explain any three problems that arose in the spread of the Non-Cooperation Movement in the towns and cities.

7. (A) 'The Treaty of Vienna of 1815 tried to restore the old order in Europe.' Analyse the statement with reference to the changes it brought. **[5]**

OR

(B) How did the printing press and the reading mania of the eighteenth century help the spread of the ideas of the Enlightenment? Examine.

8. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Jallianwala Bagh, 13 April 1919** **[4]**

> On 13 April that year, a large crowd gathered in the enclosed ground of Jallianwala Bagh. Some came to protest against the government's new repressive measures. Others had come to attend the annual Baisakhi fair. Being from outside the city, many villagers were unaware of the martial law that had been imposed. Dyer entered the area, blocked the exit points, and opened fire on the crowd, killing hundreds. His object, as he declared later, was to 'produce a moral effect', to create in the minds of satyagrahis a feeling of terror and awe. As the news of Jallianwala Bagh spread, crowds took to the streets in many north Indian towns. There were strikes, clashes with the police and attacks on government buildings. The government responded with brutal repression, seeking to humiliate and terrorise people: satyagrahis were forced to rub their noses on the ground, crawl on the streets, and do salaam to all Sahibs; people were flogged and villages around Gujranwala (now in Pakistan) were bombed.

(8.1) Why had a large crowd gathered at Jallianwala Bagh on 13 April 1919? **[1]**
(8.2) What was General Dyer's declared object in ordering the firing? **[1]**
(8.3) How did the people and the government respond after the news of the massacre spread? Explain. **[2]**

9. Two places (A) and (B) have been marked on the given political outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper). Identify them based on the information given below and write their correct names on the lines marked near them: **[2]**
(A) The place in Bihar where Gandhiji used Satyagraha for the first time in India to support peasants forced to grow indigo.
(B) The place where the Congress session of December 1920 was held.

SECTION B – GEOGRAPHY (20 Marks)

10. 'Net sown area' refers to the land: **[1]**

(A) Which is left uncultivated for more than five years
(B) On which crops are sown and harvested in a year
(C) Which is used for non-agricultural purposes
(D) Which is under forests

11. Which one of the following is a 'vulnerable' category species according to the IUCN? **[1]**

(A) Species that are in danger of extinction
(B) Species whose population has declined and may become endangered if the negative factors continue
(C) Species which are not found anywhere else
(D) Species that are no longer found in the wild

12. **Assertion (A):** The farmers of the Punjab and Haryana plains are using more water for irrigation than those of other regions. **[1]**
Reason (R): Over-irrigation has led to the problem of the falling water table in these states.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

13. Which of the following can help in the conservation of mineral resources? **[1]**
I. Using minerals in an unlimited manner
II. Recycling of metals
III. Using scrap metals
IV. Using improved technologies to allow the use of low-grade ores at low cost

(A) II, III and IV only **(B)** I, II and III only
(C) I and IV only **(D)** I, II, III and IV

14. Natural gas is increasingly being preferred as a fuel because: **[1]**

(A) It is a cleaner fuel which produces less carbon dioxide
(B) It is available in unlimited quantity
(C) It is cheaper than all other sources of energy
(D) It is a renewable source of energy

15. Which one of the following is the most important reason for the concentration of cotton textile mills in Maharashtra and Gujarat in the early days? **[1]**

(A) Availability of raw cotton, a humid climate, port facilities and a ready market
(B) Availability of coal mines nearby
(C) Absence of any other industry
(D) Large reserves of iron ore

16. Distinguish between renewable and non-renewable resources. Give one example of each. **[2]**

17. (A) Describe the geographical conditions required for the growth of rice and wheat in India. Mention one major producing state of each. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain the need for conservation of water resources. Describe any three traditional methods of rainwater harvesting.

18. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Dams as the 'temples of modern India'** **[4]**

> Jawaharlal Nehru, the first Prime Minister of India, proclaimed the dams as the 'temples of modern India'. Why? Because they would integrate the development of agriculture and the village economy with the rapid industrialisation and the growth of the urban economy. Multipurpose projects, launched after Independence with a vision of fostering development, promised to integrate the development of agriculture and the village economy with rapid industrialisation. Rivers were dammed for irrigation, electricity generation, water supply, flood control, recreation and fish breeding. In recent years, however, multipurpose projects and large dams have come under great scrutiny and opposition for a variety of reasons. Regulating and damming of rivers affects their natural flow causing poor sediment flow and excessive sedimentation at the bottom of the reservoir. Social movements like the Narmada Bachao Andolan and the Tehri Dam Andolan have been opposing the dams because they displace local communities.

(18.1) Who described dams as the 'temples of modern India'? **[1]**
(18.2) Why were multipurpose projects launched after Independence? **[1]**
(18.3) Why have social movements like the Narmada Bachao Andolan opposed large dams? Explain with two points. **[2]**

19. On the same outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper), locate and label any THREE of the following with suitable symbols: **[3]**
(i) Mumbai Port
(ii) Kaiga Nuclear Power Plant
(iii) Raja Sansi International Airport (Amritsar)
(iv) Bhakra Nangal Dam

SECTION C – POLITICAL SCIENCE (20 Marks)

20. Which one of the following best describes the 'holding together' type of federation? **[1]**
(A) A large country divides its power between the constituent states and the national government, e.g. India, Spain and Belgium
(B) Independent states come together to form a bigger unit
(C) A country with only one level of government
(D) A group of states which keep complete sovereignty

21. Which one of the following is a case of a coalition government at the Union level in India? **[1]**
(A) A government formed by an alliance of several parties after no single party won a majority
(B) A government formed by one party winning a majority
(C) A government appointed by the President without elections
(D) A government run by the Supreme Court

22. The practice of separating powers among different organs such as the legislature, executive and judiciary, so that none exercises unlimited power, is called: **[1]**
(A) Horizontal distribution of power or checks and balances
(B) Vertical division of power
(C) Community government
(D) Majoritarianism

23. Democracies accommodate social diversity when: **[1]**
(A) The majority community works with the minority and respects their identity
(B) The majority imposes its will on the minority
(C) All minorities are ignored
(D) Only one language is allowed

24. Why is the separation of powers among the legislature, the executive and the judiciary important? Give any two reasons. **[2]**

25. Explain any two ways in which the caste system in India has changed with economic development and urbanisation. **[2]**

26. How have the 1992 constitutional amendments made local government more effective? Explain any three provisions. **[3]**

27. (A) Explain the importance of the 73rd and 74th Amendments of 1992 in strengthening local government in India with any five points. **[5]**

OR

(B) 'Democracy makes the government accountable, responsive and transparent.' Examine the statement.

28. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Caste and politics** **[4]**

> When parties choose candidates in elections, they keep in mind the caste composition of the electorate and nominate candidates from different castes so as to get the necessary support to win elections. When governments are formed, political parties usually take care that representatives of different castes and tribes find a place in it. Political parties and candidates in elections make appeals to caste sentiments to muster support. Some political parties are known to favour some castes and are seen as their representatives. Universal adult franchise and the principle of one-person-one-vote compelled political leaders to gain political support and also to bring people from the lower castes into the political arena. However, it will be wrong to say that caste is the only factor in Indian politics. No parliamentary constituency in the country has a clear majority of one single caste.

(28.1) How do political parties use caste in the selection of candidates? **[1]**
(28.2) How has the system of universal adult franchise affected caste in politics? **[1]**
(28.3) Explain any two reasons why caste is not the only factor in Indian politics. **[2]**

SECTION D – ECONOMICS (20 Marks)

29. The following (hypothetical) data shows the share of three sectors in GDP and employment of a country: **[1]**
Primary: GDP 18 per cent, employment 45 per cent; Secondary: GDP 26 per cent, employment 25 per cent; Tertiary: GDP 56 per cent, employment 30 per cent.
Which one of the following conclusions is correct?

(A) The primary sector produces the most but employs the least
(B) The primary sector employs the most people but contributes the least to GDP
(C) The tertiary sector employs the most people
(D) All sectors contribute equally

30. A farmer sells sugarcane to a sugar mill. The mill produces sugar and sells it to a shopkeeper, who sells it to consumers. The correct sequence of sectors involved is: **[1]**

(A) Primary, secondary and tertiary
(B) Secondary, primary and tertiary
(C) Tertiary, secondary and primary
(D) Primary, tertiary and secondary

31. Meena works as a domestic worker in a house and is paid Rs 6,000 a month. She has no paid leave and no written contract. Her work belongs to the: **[1]**

(A) Organised sector and primary sector
(B) Unorganised sector and tertiary sector
(C) Organised sector and secondary sector
(D) Unorganised sector and secondary sector

32. If the total income of a country is Rs 5,00,000 crore and its population is 1,000 crore (hypothetical), the per capita income is: **[1]**

(A) Rs 50
(B) Rs 500
(C) Rs 5,000
(D) Rs 50,000

33. Foreign trade leads to the integration of markets of different countries because: **[1]**

(A) Goods produced in one country can reach the markets of other countries
(B) Producers must sell only within their own country
(C) Imports are banned
(D) Goods are sold only at the same price everywhere

34. On a small plot of land, 5 workers are enough to do the work, but 8 members of a family work on it. The number of workers who are in 'disguised unemployment' is: **[1]**

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 5
(D) 8

35. Why is the Public Distribution System (PDS) important for the development of a country? Explain with three points. **[3]**

36. Explain any three reasons why Self-Help Groups have become popular among rural women as a source of credit. **[3]**

37. Explain any three features of the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 which make it important for rural India. **[3]**

38. (A) 'What is development for one may not be development for another.' Explain the statement with examples and show why we need to use many criteria to compare development. **[5]**

OR

(B) Analyse the role of the public sector and the private sector in the Indian economy.

- End of Question Paper -

Career Ka Dost
Ask before you decide

MAP SHEET for Question Numbers 9 and 19

Sample Paper 4 | Roll No. _____ | Detach and attach to your answer book



Sample Paper 5

CLASS 10 | SOCIAL SCIENCE

Board Examination Practice Paper (2026-27 pattern) | Level: Hard

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: 3 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. This question paper contains **38** questions. **All questions are compulsory.**
2. The paper is divided into **four sections**: Section A (History), Section B (Geography), Section C (Political Science) and Section D (Economics). Each section carries **20 marks**.
3. **Section A:** Q1-4 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q5 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q6 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q7 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q8 is a source-based question (4 marks). Q9 is a map question (2 marks).
4. **Section B:** Q10-15 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q16 is a very short answer question (2 marks, about 40 words). Q17 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q18 is a case-based question (4 marks). Q19 is a map question (3 marks).
5. **Section C:** Q20-23 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q24 and Q25 are very short answer questions (2 marks each, about 40 words). Q26 is a short answer question (3 marks, about 60 words). Q27 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words). Q28 is a case-based question (4 marks).
6. **Section D:** Q29-34 are MCQs (1 mark each). Q35-37 are short answer questions (3 marks each, about 60 words). Q38 is a long answer question (5 marks, about 120 words).
7. There is **internal choice** in Q5, Q6, Q7, Q17, Q27, Q38. Attempt only one of the given alternatives in these questions.
8. Questions 9 and 19 are map questions. Use the **Map Sheet** given on the last page of this paper, write your Roll Number on it and attach it to your answer book.
9. Marks for each question are shown in square brackets on the right.

SECTION A – HISTORY (20 Marks)

1. Which one of the following was NOT a step taken by the French revolutionaries to create a sense of collective identity among the people of France? **[1]**

(A) A new French flag, the tricolour, replaced the royal standard

(B) Internal customs duties and dues were abolished and a uniform system of weights and measures was adopted

(C) The Estates General was elected by the body of active citizens and renamed the National Assembly

(D) Regional dialects were declared the official languages of administration in their regions

2. **Assertion (A):** The rinderpest epidemic of the 1890s in Africa affected the livelihoods of the people very badly. **[1]**

Reason (R): It killed about 90 per cent of the cattle, and the European colonisers used the loss of cattle to force Africans into the labour market.

Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

3. Read the statements about the symbols of nationalism in India: **[1]**
I. Abanindranath Tagore painted the famous image of Bharat Mata.
II. Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay wrote 'Vande Mataram' as a hymn to the motherland.
III. In 1921 Gandhiji designed the Swaraj flag with a spinning wheel in the centre.
IV. The tricolour flag was designed in 1905 during the Swadeshi movement and had a spinning wheel.
Which statements are correct?

(A) I, II and III only
(B) I, III and IV only
(C) II and IV only
(D) I, II, III and IV

4. Rashsundari Debi, whose autobiography 'Amar Jiban' was published in 1876, is remembered as: **[1]**

(A) The first full-length autobiography published in the Bengali language, written secretly in the kitchen by a woman
(B) The first woman to be elected to a legislature
(C) The editor of a Hindi daily
(D) The leader of the Salt March in Bengal

5. (A) How did the 'Civil Code' of 1804 help in making the administrative system efficient in the territories ruled by Napoleon? State any two points. **[2]**

OR

(B) How did the Zollverein promote economic nationalism in Germany? State any two points.

6. (A) Explain any three ways in which the new forms of printing helped the social reformers of India in the nineteenth century to spread their ideas. **[3]**

OR

(B) Explain any three ways in which Indian folklore helped in the growth of nationalism.

7. (A) 'Trade, conquest and disease shaped the pre-modern world.' Analyse the statement with reference to the Americas. **[5]**

OR

(B) 'The unification of Italy was the result of the efforts of Mazzini, Cavour and Garibaldi.' Analyse the statement.

8. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Indentured labour migration from India** **[4]**

> In the nineteenth century, hundreds of thousands of Indian and Chinese labourers went to work on plantations, in mines, and in road and railway construction projects around the world. In the Indian subcontinent, indentured labourers were hired under contracts that promised return travel to India after they had worked for their employers for five years. Most of the Indian indentured workers came from the present-day regions of eastern Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, central India and the dry districts of Tamil Nadu. In these regions, cottage industries declined, land rents rose, and land was cleared for mines and plantations. All these affected the lives of the poor: they failed to pay their rents, became deeply indebted and were forced to migrate in search of work. The main destinations of Indian indentured migrants were the Caribbean islands (mainly Trinidad, Guyana and Surinam), Mauritius and Fiji. Most indentured workers were recruited by agents, who often gave false information about the nature of work, living and working conditions and were not told that they were to cross the sea. In most cases the conditions of work were harsh and the labourers had few legal rights. Many of them tried to escape into the forests. By the twentieth century, an indentured contract was often described as a 'new system of slavery'.

(8.1) What was promised to the Indian indentured labourers under their contract? **[1]**
(8.2) Name any two destinations of the Indian indentured migrants. **[1]**
(8.3) Why were the indentured contracts called a 'new system of slavery'? Explain with two points. **[2]**

9. Two places (A) and (B) have been marked on the given political outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper). Identify them based on the information given below and write their correct names on the lines marked near them: **[2]**
(A) The place in Gujarat where Gandhiji organised a Satyagraha in 1917-18 to support peasants who could not pay the revenue after a crop failure.
(B) The place where the Congress session of September 1920 was held.

SECTION B – GEOGRAPHY (20 Marks)

10. Which of the following statements about the Himalayan region's soil and forests is correct? **[1]**
I. Forest soils are found in the hilly and mountainous areas where sufficient rain forests are available.
II. They are loamy and silty in valley sides and coarse-grained in the upper slopes.
III. In the snow-covered areas of the Himalayas, they experience denudation and are acidic with low humus content.
IV. They are fertile, rich in humus in the lower parts of the valleys.

(A) I, II, III and IV
(B) I and II only
(C) II and III only
(D) I and IV only

11. **Assertion (A):** Sugarcane is a tropical as well as a subtropical crop. **[1]**
Reason (R): It grows well in a hot and humid climate with a temperature of 21 to 27 degrees Celsius and an annual rainfall between 75 cm and 100 cm.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

12. **Assertion (A):** India has about 4 per cent of the world's water resources, but it faces a severe problem of water scarcity. **[1]**
Reason (R): The availability of water varies widely from place to place and from season to season, and the demand is increasing with the growing population.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

13. Which one of the following is a source of thorium in India? **[1]**

(A) Monazite sands of Kerala
(B) Coal fields of Jharkhand
(C) Petroleum fields of Assam
(D) Salt lakes of Rajasthan

14. Which one of the following is a basic raw material for the cement industry? **[1]**

(A) Limestone, silica, alumina and gypsum
(B) Iron ore and coking coal
(C) Cotton and jute
(D) Bauxite and cryolite

15. Sugar mills are generally located near the sugarcane-growing areas. The main reason for this is that: **[1]**

(A) Sugarcane loses its weight and sucrose content if it is transported over long distances and has to be processed quickly
(B) Sugarcane can be grown only near sugar mills
(C) Sugar mills require imported machinery
(D) Sugarcane is a heavy and non-perishable raw material

16. How have 'sacred groves' helped in the conservation of forests? Explain with two points. **[2]**

17. (A) 'Water scarcity in most cases is caused by over-exploitation, excessive use and unequal access to water among different social groups.' Analyse the statement. **[5]**

OR

(B) 'Multipurpose river projects have become a source of conflicts and displacement.' Evaluate the statement with reference to the Narmada Bachao Andolan.

18. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Controlling industrial pollution: the NTPC example** **[4]**

> The National Thermal Power Corporation (NTPC) has taken many steps to control pollution. Steps taken by the corporation include: optimum utilisation of equipment by adopting the latest techniques and upgrading existing equipment; minimising waste generation by maximising ash utilisation; providing green belts for nurturing ecological balance and addressing environmental issues; reducing environmental pollution through ash pond management, ash water recycling system and liquid waste management; and ecological monitoring, reviews and online database management for all its power stations. Industries can also reduce water pollution by minimising the use of water, by reusing and recycling water in two or more successive stages, by harvesting rainwater to meet water requirements, and by treating hot water and effluents before releasing them in rivers and ponds.

(18.1) Name any one step taken by NTPC to control pollution. **[1]**
(18.2) How do green belts help in addressing the problem of pollution? **[1]**
(18.3) Suggest any two measures by which industries can reduce the pollution of water. **[2]**

19. On the same outline map of India (Map Sheet at the end of this paper), locate and label any THREE of the following with suitable symbols: **[3]**
(i) Kalpakkam Nuclear Power Plant
(ii) Software Technology Park at Thiruvananthapuram
(iii) Tehri Dam
(iv) Kochi Port

SECTION C – POLITICAL SCIENCE (20 Marks)

20. Which one of the following is a feature that distinguishes federalism from a unitary system? **[1]**
(A) Powers are divided between the central government and the constituent units, and each has its own sphere of authority
(B) Only one level of government exists
(C) The state governments are appointed by the central government
(D) Local governments make the national laws

21. Read the statements about the political parties: **[1]**
I. They contest elections and form governments.
II. They put forward different policies and programmes.
III. They shape public opinion.
IV. They are not required to work for the people once they are elected.
Which statements are correct?
(A) I, II and III only
(B) I, III and IV only
(C) II and IV only
(D) I, II, III and IV

22. **Assertion (A):** In a democracy, the horizontal distribution of power is considered to be an important form of power sharing. **[1]**
Reason (R): It allows different organs of government such as the legislature, executive and judiciary to exercise different powers, so that none of them can exercise unlimited power.
Choose the correct option.
(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

23. The women's movements around the world in the early twentieth century demanded: **[1]**
(A) Equal political rights such as the right to vote, and equal opportunities in education and careers
(B) A ban on women's education
(C) Separate states for women
(D) Exclusion of women from politics

24. How does democracy provide a method to deal with differences, divisions and conflicts in a society? Explain in two points. **[2]**

25. How has the Right to Information Act, 2005 helped in making the government accountable? Explain in two points. **[2]**

26. Examine any three differences between the way Belgium and Sri Lanka handled their ethnic diversity. **[3]**

27. (A) 'Women still face disadvantages and discrimination in India.' Evaluate the statement and suggest ways to improve their position. **[5]**

OR

(B) Explain what is meant by communalism and describe the forms it can take. Suggest how it can be countered.

28. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow. **Why do we need political parties?** **[4]**

> Political parties are easily one of the most visible institutions in a democracy. For most ordinary citizens, democracy is equal to political parties. If you go to any village in India, you will find that people may not know anything about the Constitution or the nature of the government. But you will find that they know something about our political parties. At the same time, this visibility does not mean popularity. Most people are very critical of the political parties. They tend to blame parties for all that is wrong with our democracy and our public life. Parties have become identified with social and political divisions. Yet, a political party is a group of people who come together to contest elections and hold power in the government. They agree on some policies and programmes for the society with a view to promote the collective good. Parties reflect fundamental political divisions in a society.

(28.1) What is a political party? **[1]**
(28.2) Why is the visibility of political parties not the same as their popularity? **[1]**
(28.3) Why can a democracy not function without political parties? Explain with two points. **[2]**

SECTION D – ECONOMICS (20 Marks)

29. The data of two countries are given: **[1]**
Country P: per capita income Rs 1,10,000; life expectancy 60 years; literacy rate 70 per cent.
Country Q: per capita income Rs 80,000; life expectancy 74 years; literacy rate 90 per cent.
Which of the following conclusions is the most appropriate?

(A) Country Q may have a higher human development index because it performs better in health and education in spite of a lower income
(B) Country P must have a higher human development index because its income is higher
(C) Both countries have the same level of development
(D) Human development cannot be compared using life expectancy and literacy

30. Which one of the following is NOT a reason for the growing importance of the tertiary sector in India? **[1]**

(A) A decline in the demand for transport, trade and storage services
(B) The need for basic services like hospitals, education, banking and administration
(C) Rising income levels leading to demand for services like tourism and shopping
(D) The growth of new services such as those based on information and communication technology

31. **Assertion (A):** Disguised unemployment is found in the agricultural sector. **[1]**
Reason (R): In disguised unemployment, more people than needed are engaged in work and the total production does not fall even if some of them are removed.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

32. State A has a literacy rate of 90 per cent and an infant mortality rate of 12 per 1,000 live births. State B has a literacy rate of 70 per cent and an infant mortality rate of 40. Which statement is the most appropriate? **[1]**

(A) State A is better developed in terms of health and education
(B) State B is better developed in terms of health and education
(C) Both states have the same level of development
(D) Development cannot be compared using literacy and infant mortality

33. **Assertion (A):** Foreign trade leads to the integration of markets across countries. **[1]**
Reason (R): Goods produced in one country reach the markets of other countries, giving buyers more choices and making prices of the same goods in different countries similar.
Choose the correct option.

(A) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(C) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(D) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

34. Which one of the following is true about the use of money in modern times? **[1]**

(A) Currency notes and coins are accepted as a medium of exchange because the government of the country authorises their use
(B) Gold coins are the only legal currency
(C) Money is no longer needed as barter has returned
(D) Only banks can accept money

35. 'Per capita income alone is not sufficient to compare the level of development of different states.' Explain the statement with the example of Kerala and Haryana. **[3]**

36. Explain the meaning of 'underemployment' with the example of agriculture. Why is it widespread in India? **[3]**

37. Explain any three reasons why the poor families of rural India take loans from the informal sources even though the interest rate is higher. **[3]**

38. (A) Evaluate the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 and the other measures taken by the government to increase employment in the country. **[5]**

OR

(B) Why is it necessary to protect the workers of the unorganised sector? Suggest five measures to protect them.

- End of Question Paper -

MAP SHEET for Question Numbers 9 and 19

Sample Paper 5 | Roll No. _____ | Detach and attach to your answer book



All the Best!

You have done the hard work. Now go and show it on the paper.

Exam-day reminders

1	Read the whole paper once and start with the section you are most confident about.
2	Give about 40 minutes to each section and keep 20 minutes for revision.
3	Stick to the word limits: 40 words for 2 marks, 60 for 3 marks and 120 for 5 marks.
4	For case-based questions, answer only from the passage and the question asked.
5	Practise the map in pencil first, then mark and label neatly with the correct symbols.
6	Attempt every question. There is internal choice, so pick the one you know best.
7	Solve the 5 papers one by one, from Paper 1 (easy) to Paper 5 (hard), in exam conditions and revise from NCERT after each.

Career Ka Dost
Ask before you decide